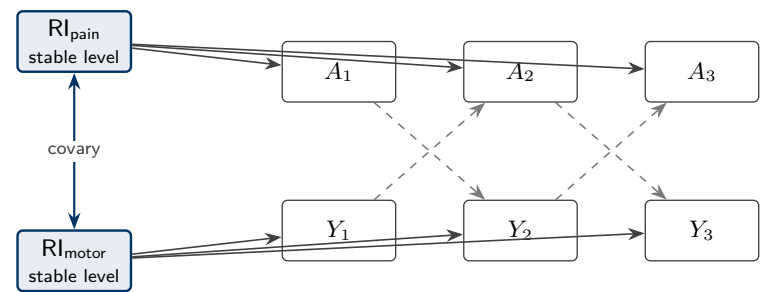
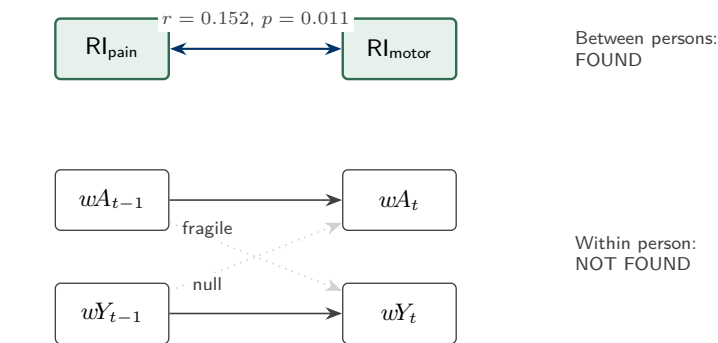


A Why a conventional cross-lagged model reports both directions

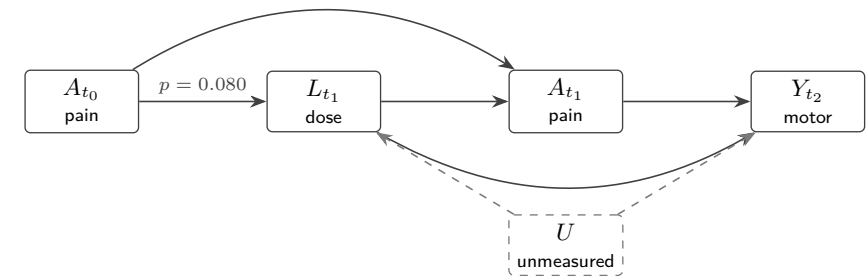


Dashed arrows are not effects. They are what the estimator reports when it cannot see the stable levels: every repeated observation of a person is displaced in the same direction, and that displacement is read as one series predicting the other.

B What each component estimates once separated

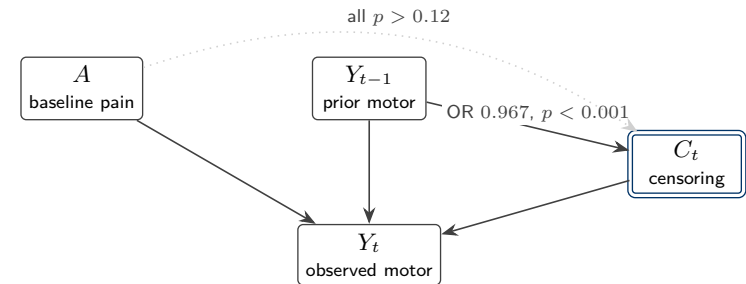


C Dopaminergic dose as a time-varying confounder affected by prior exposure



Conditioning on L blocks part of the path and opens a collider path through U ; not conditioning leaves confounding by indication. Both options are biased. The marginal structural model is justified only if $A_{t_0} \rightarrow L_{t_1}$ exists, and in these data it does not ($p = 0.080$), so it is reported as a sensitivity analysis.

D Structure of censoring by attrition



Censoring depends on the outcome but not on the exposure. That is why the stabilised censoring weights sit close to one and barely move the estimates, which bounds how far attrition can have distorted them. The double box marks the variable the analysis conditions on.